Sergiu Lipcean

Comparative politics scholar

Political financing · Political corruption · Political parties · Public participation

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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

12/2022–05/2026 **Research Fellow** • *University of Bergen*
Department of Comparative Politics. ERC project *ConsultationEffects*: Effects of Stakeholder Consultations on Inputs, Processes and Outcomes of Executive Policymaking. Bergen, Norway.

11/2020–10/2022 **Marie Curie Postdoctoral Fellow** • *Dublin City University*
School of Law and Government. Horizon 2020 project *PFCORR*: Does Public Funding Matter? Dublin, Ireland.

09/2019–08/2020 **Politics Lecturer** • *State University 'Dimitrie Cantemir'*
Research Methods, Comparative Politics. Chisinau, Moldova.

01/2009–02/2020 **Associated Political Expert** • *IDIS 'Viitorul'*
Institute for Development and Social Initiatives. Party and campaign financing, education policies, parliamentary monitoring. Chisinau, Moldova.

09/2007–07/2011 **Politics Lecturer** • *University of Political and Economic European Studies*
Introduction to Public Policy, Contemporary Political Ideas, Comparative Politics. Chisinau, Moldova.

09/2006–06/2008 **Politics Lecturer** • *State Institute of International Relations*
Introduction to Public Policy, Contemporary Political Ideas. Chisinau, Moldova.

09/2001–06/2007 **Politics Lecturer** • *Institute of Political Studies and International Relations*
Introduction to Public Policy, Contemporary Political Ideas, Comparative Politics. Chisinau, Moldova.

EDUCATION

09/2014–04/2019 **PhD in Political and Social Sciences** • *European University Institute*
Florence, Italy. Dissertation: *Similar Challenges, Different Outcomes? The Development of Political Financing Regimes in Post-Communist Space*.

09/2013–08/2014 **MRes in Political and Social Sciences** • *European University Institute*
Florence, Italy.

09/2011–09/2013 **MA in East European and Eurasian Studies** • *University of Bologna*
Forlì Campus, Italy.

09/1999–06/2001 **Postgraduate Studies in Political Sciences** • *National School of Political and Administrative Studies*
Bucharest, Romania.

09/1998–06/1999 **MA in History** • *Moldova State University*
Chisinau, Moldova.

09/1993–06/1998 **BA in History** • *Moldova State University*
Chisinau, Moldova.

RESEARCH GRANTS, FELLOWSHIPS & PROJECTS

09/2023–08/2027	**Principal Investigator** • *Pathway Programme Research Fellowship* Irish Research Council & Science Foundation Ireland, Dublin City University (€436,035).†
11/2020–10/2022	**Marie Curie Postdoctoral Fellow** • *MSCA Individual Fellowship* Horizon 2020, Dublin City University (PFCorr, Grant ID 895004 — €184,590).
09/2016–08/2017	**PhD Fellowship** • *European University Institute* Internal funding (€15,360), Florence, Italy.
09/2013–08/2016	**PhD Fellowship** • *European University Institute* Italian Ministry of Foreign Affairs grant (€41,400), Florence, Italy.
12/2017–04/2018	**Researcher** • *Political Finance Database project* International IDEA, Stockholm, Sweden.
02/2017–04/2017	**Research Assistant** • *ERC Project POLCON* European University Institute, Florence, Italy.
05/2015–12/2015	**Research Assistant** • *ERC Project POLCON* European University Institute, Florence, Italy.
11/2013–05/2014	**Research Assistant** • *EUandI — VAA for 2014 EP elections* European University Institute, Florence, Italy.

† Declined the awarded research grant for family reasons.

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

Lipcean, S. Can Direct Public Funding of Political Parties Curb Corruption? Evidence of Diminishing Returns from Post-Communist Regimes. (Revise & Resubmit) *Perspectives on Politics*

Bunea, A., Lipcean, S. & Rauh, C. (2026). Responsive to What? Explaining the Information Quality of Public Comments on Bureaucratic Policymaking Using a Text-as-Data Approach. *Governance* 39(2): e70122. DOI

Bunea, A. & Lipcean, S. (2026). Does public participation in supranational policymaking enhance the European Commission's legislative agenda-setting success? *Journal of European Public Policy*. DOI

Casal Bértoa, F., Horncastle, W. & Lipcean, S. (2025). Blessing or Curse? A Critical Review of the Paradoxical Consequences of Direct Public Funding for Political Parties. *European Political Science Review* 1–21. DOI

Lipcean, S. & Casal Bértoa, F. (2024). Do political finance reforms really reduce corruption? A replication study. *Research & Politics* 11(4): 1–9. DOI

Lipcean, S. & McMenamin, I. (2024). Rethinking public funding of parties and corruption: Confronting theoretical complexity and challenging measurement. *Governance* 37(2): 537–559. DOI

Bunea, A., Wüest, R. & Lipcean, S. (2024). Mapping the policy space of public stakeholder consultations: Evidence from the European Union. *Journal of European Public Policy*. DOI

Bunea, A. & Lipcean, S. (2023). Understanding patterns of stakeholder participation in public commenting on bureaucratic policymaking: Evidence from the European Union. *Regulation & Governance*. DOI

Lipcean, S. (2022). Direct public funding of political parties: Between proxy measures and hard data. *Party Politics* 28(6): 1041–1057. DOI

Datasets

Lipcean, S. (2021). Dataset on direct public funding of political parties across post-communist regimes 1990–2020. *Harvard Dataverse*. DOI

Book Chapters

Lipcean, S. & Casal Bértoa, F. (2024). Political Financing and Political Corruption. In L. de Sousa & S. Coroado (eds.), *Elgar Encyclopedia of Corruption and Society*. DOI

Lipcean, S. & Prohnitchi, E. (2024). Against The Mainstream? The Impact of Party Regulation in Political Competition in Moldova. In F. Casal Bértoa & L. Tsutskiridze (eds.), *Money Rules: Parties, Oligarchs and Funding Regulation in*

Post-Soviet Countries. Routledge. DOI

Policy Briefs & Reports

Lipcean, S. (2026). Campaign Financing in Moldova's 2025 Parliamentary Elections. In J. M. Dollbaum & A. Eaglestone (eds.), *Moldovan Analytical Digest*. The Parliamentary Elections of 2025 II. Univ. of Fribourg; FSO Bremen; CSS & CEES, ETH/Univ. Zurich. DOI

Lipcean, S., Casal Bértoa, F. & Goguadze, N. (2022). Post-legislative scrutiny of election campaign finance legislation. London: Westminster Foundation for Democracy. URL

Berbeca, V. & Lipcean, S. (2020). National Army: Between Group Interests and Strategic Development. Institute of Public Policies (ro). URL

Lipcean, S. & Turcan, R. (2020). Higher Education in Moldova at Crossroads or Throwing Good Money After Bad? Chisinau: Friedrich Ebert Stiftung. URL

Lipcean, S. (2018). Drawing Electoral Districts Boundaries: Between Neutrality and Political Partisanship. Chisinau: Friedrich Ebert Stiftung, IDIS 'Viitorul'. URL

Lipcean, S. (2017). Problems and Challenges in the Financing of Parliamentary Elections in the Context of Changing the Electoral System. Chisinau: Friedrich Ebert Stiftung, IDIS 'Viitorul'. URL

Lipcean, S. & Ştefan, L. (2014). Implementing Right to Information: A Case Study of Moldova. In S. E. Trapnell (ed.), *Right to Information: Case Studies on Implementation*. Washington, DC: World Bank. URL

Ciurea, C., Gurin, M., Lipcean, S. & Berbeca, V. (2012). Higher Education System of Moldova in the Context of the Bologna Process: 2005–2011. Soros Foundation Moldova & IDIS 'Viitorul' (ro). URL

Lipcean, S. (2011). Free and Fair Elections. In *The Audit of the Democratic System of Republic of Moldova*. IDIS 'Viitorul', pp. 80–113. URL

Lipcean, S. (2011). The Democratic Role of Political Parties. In *The Audit of the Democratic System of Republic of Moldova*. IDIS 'Viitorul', pp. 114–142.

Lipcean, S. (2011). Government Effectiveness and Accountability. In *The Audit of the Democratic System of Republic of Moldova*. IDIS 'Viitorul', pp. 143–164.

Lipcean, S. (2011). Vocational Education at Crossroads: A Policy Decision Analysis of the Post–Secondary Vocational Education System of Moldova. IDIS 'Viitorul' (ro). URL

Ciurea, C. & Lipcean, S. (2011). Financing of Political Parties in the 2011 Local Elections: a Sample of Medieval Relations (No. 6). Chişinău: IDIS 'Viitorul' (ro). URL

Lipcean, S., Ciurea, C., Litra, L. & Cozonac, C. (2010). Financing Political Parties: Between Transparency and Obscurity (No. 8). Chişinău: IDIS 'Viitorul'. URL

Lipcean, S. (2009). Assessing the Financing of Political Parties and Election Campaigns in the Republic of Moldova (No. 5). Chişinău: IDIS 'Viitorul' (ro). URL

METHOD TRAINING

02/2022 **ECPR Winter School** • *Virtual*
Machine Learning with Big Data (R); Social Network Analysis (R).

08/2021 **ECPR Summer School** • *Virtual*
Structural Equation Modelling (R); Quantitative Text Analysis (R); Statistics of Causal Inference (R).

03/2021 **ECPR Winter School** • *Virtual*
Panel Data Analysis (R); Multilevel Modelling (R).

05/2017 **Workshops** • *European University Institute*
A Primer to Web Scraping with R; Qualitative Comparative Analysis (QCA) with R.

05/2016 **Workshop** • *European University Institute*
QCA and Fuzzy Sets.

03/2016 **Workshop** • *European University Institute*
Introduction to Data Analysis with R.

05/2015 **Workshop** • *European University Institute*
Introduction to Panel Data Analysis.

02/2015 **Workshops** • *European University Institute*
Causal Inference: Design-Based Identification Strategies; Social-Scientific Network Analysis; Categorical Dependent Variables.

SELECTED CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

04/2026 **IPSA-RC20 Biennial Meeting** • *Institute of Social Sciences, University of Lisbon, Portugal*
Political Constraints, Electoral Systems, and Public Funding of Political Parties.

08/2024 **IPSA-RC20 Biennial Meeting** • *Oxford University, UK*
Party funding control and corruption: Evidence from the European Union.

07/2024 **Money in Politics in the Era of Globalization and Digitalization** • *Chisinau, Moldova*
The Challenges of Party Funding Control.

06/2024 **8th Interdisciplinary Corruption Research Forum** • *Lisbon, Portugal*
Hide-and-Seek: Untangling Judicial Corruption Through the Scrutiny of Income and Asset Declarations.

11/2023 **CERIS Workshop on Anti-Corruption** • *European Commission, Brussels*
The Impact of Public Funding of Political Parties on Political Corruption.

09/2023 **ECPR General Conference** • *Prague, Czechia*
Does public funding of political parties affect party systems and electoral competition? Evidence from the post-communist space.

07/2023 **ECPR Standing Group on Regulatory Governance** • *Antwerp, Belgium*
Understanding patterns of public commenting on bureaucratic policymaking: Evidence from the European Union.

09/2022 **APSA Annual Meeting** • *Montreal, Canada*
Does Public Funding of Parties Reduce Corruption? Evidence from Firm-Level Data.

07/2022 **IPSA-RC20 Biennial Meeting** • *Prague, Czechia*
Does public funding of parties reduce corruption? Evidence from firm-level data.

06/2022 **EPSA Annual Conference** • *Prague, Czechia*
Does state funding of political parties reduce political corruption? Evidence from the post-communist space.

04/2022 **ECPR Joint Sessions** • *Virtual*
Workshop Co-Chair & presentation: Does Public Funding of Parties Reduce Corruption?

04/2022 **MPSA Annual Conference** • *Virtual*
Does State Funding of Political Parties Reduce Political Corruption? Evidence from the Post-Communist Space.

09/2021 **ECPR General Conference** • *Virtual*
Does state funding of political parties deter political corruption? New insights from hard data.

07/2017 **IPSA-RC20 Biennial Meeting** • *Valencia, Spain*
Assessing the Restrictiveness of Party Funding Regimes: Towards an Analytical Framework.

09/2016 **ECPR General Conference** • *Prague, Czechia*
Similar Challenges — Different Outcomes: Addressing the Supply and Demand Sides of Party Funding Regulations in Post-Communist Space.

ACADEMIC COMMUNITY SERVICE

03/2026	**Co-organiser & Instructor** • *National Agency for Research and Development, Republic of Moldova* Workshop: Introduction to Data Management, Analysis and Visualisation with R (40 hours direct contact).
04/2022	**Co-Chair** • *ECPR Joint Sessions Workshop* *Measuring Corruption: State of the Art, Challenges, and Advancements*, University of Edinburgh.
05/2022	**Co-organiser & Instructor** • *Dublin City University* Workshop: Introduction to Data Management with R. School of Law and Government & Anti-Corruption Research Centre.
05/2022	**Co-organiser & Instructor** • *Dublin City University* Workshop: Introduction to Data Visualisation with R. School of Law and Government & Anti-Corruption Research Centre.
2020–2026	**Reviewer** • *Journals* Party Politics; Representation; Problems of Post-Communism; Journal of Public Affairs; Journal of European Integration; Governance; Government & Opposition.

SKILLS

Software	**R / RStudio** — data collection (including web scraping), management, analysis, and visualisation. **Microsoft Office** — Excel, Outlook, PowerPoint, Word.
Quantitative methods	**Using R** — panel data models, mixed effects models, marginal structural models, beta regression models, count data models (e.g. Poisson, binomial), sample selection models (e.g. Heckman).
Qualitative methods	Process tracing, comparative case study analysis.
Languages	**Romanian** — mother tongue; **Russian** — native-level proficiency; **English** — fluent; **Italian** — intermediate.